start you on your quest of digging for more information on the subject. If and when cyborgs become a reality, it will only be after we have proven interfaces and radically new ideas that work. Screens and touch interfaces might be on their way out soon, so pay close attention if you happen to be starting off a career in tech right about now...

Elon Musk

We have no choice but to start pretty much any forward looking article with this man. The rock star of the technology world, Musk is what we wish every tech billionaire would be, or at least he is what we daydream about being if we were billionaires. We don't know if the man is a genius or he is smart enough to listen to the awesome people he has working around him, but he seems to have a finger in every pie that's promising for the future. He's the type of person who will casually tweet about "building a cyborg dragon", and instead of just laughing it off as a joke, the world waits with bated breath for the 'grand' reveal.

The billionaire we all want to be

We're not mentioning him because of his cyborg dragon though – which we think is a Human + SpaceX Dragon rocket hybrid control system, and are probably wrong about. We're starting off with him because he co-founded a company called Neuralink, which aims to create "ultra high bandwidth brain-machine interfaces to connect humans and computers."

Musk has talked about trying to develop a technology similar to the fictional neural lace that is described in the Culture series of novels by noted scottish sci-fi author Iain Banks.

In 2015 scientists from Harvard published a paper showing how they had developed a nanotech neural lace that could be injected into the brain and fused with brain cells to form a mesh that picks up and can transfer electric activity from and to neurons. They'd successfully injected it into mice, and the mice seemed to be thriving without adverse effects. They were still a long way away from being able to hook up a computer directly to the neural lace and tell the mouse what to do, or even to communicate and read the thoughts of the mouse... but we do know that soon after Elon Musk and others in the same field started up Neuralink... coincidence? We'd certainly like to disagree.

Musk is also famous for being wary of artificial intelligence, and sees the neural lace as a way of evening the odds against true AI. With the neural lace, a human brain could essentially send and receive data as fast as a computer, without involving cumbersome and restrictive interfaces like the eyes, or speech, and literally compute at the speed of thought.

Amber Case

Amber is an American Cyborg Anthropologist, and is one of the people who most influenced our decision to write this cover story to begin with. She also thinks that we are all Cyborgs already, and her definition is what we've used in the first article written by Agent 001.

Amber studies us cyborgs and has some interesting insights...

Amber loves studying and researching modern humans, and how we interface with technology. She is a critic of the UIs that we have all around us, because she firmly believes that we have merely taken the desktop, which is a device designed to usurp 100 per cent of your attention, and ported it to mobile devices. Like many others, she also believes that mobile devices are just designed wrong, and are causing a lot of the stress and exhaustion that we experience. Because of the lack of downtime, and us having desktops in our pocket (which we cannot shut down and walk away from), we're also suffering major health problems. She uses her research and her insight to help design what she and others before her have termed Calm Technology. This is nothing more than the opposite of the disruptive and invasive technology that we are used to. The opposite of having desktops within our pockets.

She and many others, us included, believe that well designed technology disappears, and allows you to focus on the task at hand, rather than the technology itself. Because human attention is the new currency of the world, everyone wants a piece of the pie, which results in what I have termed as the train station effect. You could call it the fish market effect, or anything really, so long as it depicts a crowded and noisy part of our lives, where because everyone is shouting, all your brain can really do is pretty much ignore everything as noise.

We can't really blame companies for trying to make money by grabbing your attention, but Amber sees a revolution coming where we rebel against the way things are and seek out calm technology solutions. To give you an example of what she considers calm technology, she's set up a Philips Hue lightbulb in her kitchen, and coded a controller to connect to the local weather reports, and change the colour of the bulb to reflect the weather outside / expected weather for today. Because she wakes up early, she able to sit in her kitchen, drinking her morning coffee, and "feel" the weather for the day. If it's going to be raining, it's dark blue, if it's a light drizzle, it's